Lesson 30

THE WORD OF GOD

Aim: To impart to the believer the importance of the Word of God in Christian growth.

Introduction:

"Within the covers of the Bible are the answers for all the problems men face." - Ronald Reagan

"A thorough knowledge of the Bible is worth more than a college education." - Theodore Roosevelt

The aim of a Christian disciple is to grow more like Jesus. As our human body needs food daily in order to become strong and mature.

I. THE IMPORTANCE OF THE WORD OF GOD.

A. The Word of God is our spiritual nourishment.

Matthew 4:4 *"But he answered and said, It is written, Man shall not live by bread alone, but by every word that proceedeth out of the mouth of God."*

1 Peter 2:1,2 *"As newborn babes, desire the sincere milk of the word, that ye may grow thereby:" KJV "Like newborn babies, crave pure spiritual milk, so that by it you may grow up in your salvation,"* NIV B. The Word of God is our light.

Psalm 119:105 *"Your word is a lamp to my feet and a light for my path."*

B. The Word of God is our weapon.

Hebrews 4:12 *"For the word of God is living and active. Sharper than any double edged sword, it penetrates even to dividing soul and spirit, joints and marrow; it judges the thoughts and attitudes of the heart."*

C. The Word of God is the Truth that will set us free.

John 8:32 *"Then you will know the truth, and the truth will set you free."*

D. The Word of God is our Equipper.

2 Timothy 3:16,17 *"All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, so that the man of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work."*

E. The Word of God is our source of life and health.

Proverbs 4:20-22

20 *My son, pay attention to what I say; listen closely to my words.*

21 *Do not let them out of your sight, keep them within your heart;*

22 *for they are life to those who find them and health to a man's whole body.*

II. HOW WAS THE BIBLE WRITTEN?

A. 1 Peter 1:20-21

20 Above all, you must understand that no prophecy of Scripture came about by the prophet's own interpretation. 21 For prophecy never had its origin in the will of man, but men spoke from God as they were carried along by the Holy Spirit.

B. 2 Timothy 3:16

16 All Scripture is God-breathed and is useful for teaching, rebuking, correcting and training in righteousness, 17 so that the man of God may be thoroughly equipped for every good work.

III. THE AUTHORITY OF GOD'S WORD

A. It is guaranteed by God.

Jeremiah 11:1-4

1 This is the word that came to Jeremiah from the LORD:2 "Listen to the terms of this covenant and tell them to the people of Judah and to those who live in Jerusalem.3 Tell them that this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Cursed is the man who does not obey the terms of this covenant-4 the terms I commanded your forefathers when I brought them out of Egypt, out of the iron-smelting furnace.' I said, 'Obey me and do everything I command you, and you will be my people, and I will be your God.

Isaiah 55:11 *"so is my word that goes out from my mouth: It will not return to me empty, but will accomplish what I desire and achieve the purpose for which I sent it."* B. It is eternal or permanent.

Psalm 119:89 *"Your word, O LORD, is eternal; it stands firm in the heavens."*

IV. APPLICATION

A. Hear - Romans 10:17

17 Consequently, faith comes from hearing the message, and the message is heard through the word of Christ.

B. Read - Isaiah 34:16

16 Look in the scroll of the LORD and read: None of these will be missing, not one will lack her mate. For it is his mouth that has given the order, and his Spirit will gather them together.

C. Study- 2 Timothy 2:15

15 Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a workman who does not need to be ashamed and who correctly handles the word of truth.

D. Meditate - Psalm 1:1-3

1 Blessed is the man who does not walk in the counsel of the wicked or stand in the way of sinners or sit in the seat of mockers. 2 But his delight is in the law of the LORD, and on his law he meditates day and night. 3 He is like a tree planted by streams of water, which yields its fruit in season and whose leaf does not wither. Whatever he does prospers.

E. Obey - John 14:21

21 Whoever has my commands and obeys them, he is the one who loves me. He who loves me will be loved by my Father, and I too will love him and show myself to him."